

AI-ASSISTED LOGISTICS CUSTOMER SERVICE

Prompting Strategies • Delivery Delay Communication

BBA Logistics and Supply Chain Management | CLO04

Student Name: _____

Roll Number: _____

Batch: _____

Date: _____

AI Tool Used: _____

Fictional classroom case study | No live shipment tracking

Portfolio Snapshot

This portfolio documents an AI-assisted customer-service workflow for a fictional delayed shipment. It demonstrates six prompting approaches, evaluates unsupported claims, adapts information for customers and warehouse staff, and updates messages when operational timings change.

Portfolio detail	Description
Fictional company	FreshRoute Logistics
Shipment / customer	FR208 / GreenBasket Retail
Cargo	100 cartons of packaged biscuits
Route	Delhi warehouse → Jaipur retail distribution centre
Original estimated delivery	12 October 2026, 4:00 PM
Updated estimated delivery	12 October 2026, 6:00 PM
Updated next customer update	12 October 2026, 3:00 PM
Delay cause / recovery	Vehicle breakdown; replacement vehicle arranged and cargo transfer in progress
Policy boundary	Customer may request delivery-fee review for a delay of 4+ hours; refund is not automatic and requires approval

Source limitation: the company and policy are fictional. Delivery time is an estimate, not a guarantee. Cargo condition, delivery fee, refund amount, driver contact number and live vehicle location have not been provided.

How to use this portfolio

Fill in the cover-page details.

Use the prompts and example outputs as a working draft; run the prompts in your AI tool if screenshots are required.

Insert readable screenshots at the marked evidence points.

Personalise the observation and reflection sections in your own words.

Complete the final manual-verification table before submitting.

Source Facts and Timeline

Field	Original information	After live change
Shipment ID	FR208	FR208
Scheduled delivery	12 Oct 2026, 10:00 AM	12 Oct 2026, 10:00 AM
Estimated delivery	12 Oct 2026, 4:00 PM	12 Oct 2026, 6:00 PM
Next customer update	12 Oct 2026, 1:00 PM	12 Oct 2026, 3:00 PM
Delay duration from schedule	6 hours	8 hours
Reason	Vehicle breakdown during transit	Unchanged

Field	Original information	After live change
Recovery	Replacement vehicle arranged; cargo transfer in progress	Unchanged
Fee review policy	May request review for delay of 4+ hours; refund requires approval	Unchanged; approval still required

Manual calculation: scheduled delivery at 10:00 AM to the original estimate of 4:00 PM is a six-hour delay. The updated estimate of 6:00 PM is an eight-hour delay. Both exceed the four-hour threshold for requesting a delivery-fee review; neither creates an automatic refund entitlement.

Round 1 — Zero-Shot Prompting

Purpose: establish a baseline by asking for a delayed-shipment message without giving the shipment facts.

Exact prompt:

Write a customer message about a delayed shipment.

Illustrative output:

Dear Customer, we apologise that your shipment has been delayed. We are working to resolve the issue and will provide an update as soon as more information is available. Thank you for your patience.

Review notes

Limitation 1: the message does not identify shipment FR208, customer GreenBasket Retail or the route.

Limitation 2: it omits the revised estimated delivery time, the breakdown reason, the recovery action and the next update time.

Unsupported claim check: this illustrative response does not name a specific unsupported benefit or time. However, "working to resolve the issue" should be used only when supported by recovery information; the source later confirms a replacement vehicle has been arranged.

Observation starter: The zero-shot response was polite but generic. It needed verified shipment details and a clear update time before it could be sent.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Round 1 prompt and your AI tool's response.

Round 2 — Context and Constraints

Exact prompt:

Using only the shipment information supplied, write a professional customer email within 120 words. Include a subject line, shipment ID, scheduled delivery, revised estimated delivery, delay reason, recovery action and next update. Briefly explain the delivery-fee review policy. Do not invent a refund amount, driver contact number, live location or cargo condition. Do not guarantee the estimated delivery time.

Example customer email — original timeline

Subject: Delivery Update for Shipment FR208

Dear GreenBasket Retail Team,

We apologise for the delay to shipment FR208, containing 100 cartons of packaged biscuits, travelling from our Delhi warehouse to your Jaipur retail distribution centre. Delivery was scheduled for 12 October 2026 at 10:00 AM and is now estimated for 4:00 PM due to a vehicle breakdown during transit. A replacement vehicle has been arranged, and cargo transfer is in progress. Our next update is scheduled for 1:00 PM on 12 October. Under our fictional policy, you may request a delivery-fee review for delays of four hours or more; any refund is not automatic and requires approval. Cargo condition has not yet been confirmed.

Improvements over Round 1:

The email names the shipment, cargo, route, scheduled time, estimate and cause.

It describes the recovery action and update time while explaining that a fee review is only a request and refunds require approval.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Round 2 context prompt and email.

Round 3 — Role Prompting

Exact prompt:

Act as a logistics customer service executive at FreshRoute Logistics. Rewrite the previous email in a calm, respectful and accountable tone. Acknowledge that the delay may affect the customer's planning. Preserve all supplied facts, stay within 120 words and do not add promises or unverified information.

Example output

Subject: Shipment FR208 — Delivery Update

Dear GreenBasket Retail Team,

We understand this delay may affect your planning, and we apologise for the inconvenience. Shipment FR208, carrying 100 cartons of packaged biscuits from Delhi to Jaipur, was scheduled for 10:00 AM on 12 October 2026 and is now estimated to arrive at 4:00 PM following a vehicle breakdown during transit. A replacement vehicle has been arranged and cargo transfer is in progress. We will update you at 1:00 PM. You may request a delivery-fee review for a delay of four hours or more; any refund requires approval. Cargo condition has not yet been confirmed.

Tone observation: “We understand this delay may affect your planning” recognises the customer’s operational needs without promising compensation or a guaranteed delivery.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Round 3 role prompt and revised email.

Round 4 — Few-Shot Prompting

Exact prompt:

Follow this concise question-and-answer style:
Customer: “What is my shipment reference?”
Response: “Your shipment reference is FR208.”
Customer: “When will I receive the next update?”
Response: “Your next update is scheduled for 12 October 2026 at 1:00 PM.”
Now answer: Why is my shipment delayed? What is being done to recover it? Will I automatically receive a refund? Can you confirm all cartons are undamaged? Use only the supplied facts. Keep each answer within two sentences. If information is unavailable, state that clearly and refer the customer to the logistics support desk.

Customer question	Response
Why is my shipment delayed?	The vehicle carrying shipment FR208 broke down during transit. We apologise for the inconvenience.
What is being done to recover the shipment?	A replacement vehicle has been arranged and cargo transfer is in progress.
Will I automatically receive a refund?	No automatic refund is confirmed. You may request a delivery-fee review for a delay of four hours or more, and any refund requires approval.
Can you confirm all cartons are undamaged?	Cargo condition has not been confirmed. Please contact the logistics support desk for assistance or further information.

How examples influence output: they encourage short, consistent answers with a clear response label. They do not provide new operational facts.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Round 4 few-shot prompt and answers.

Round 5 — Structured-Output Prompting

Customer question	Answer based on supplied information	Missing information or approval needed
When was delivery originally scheduled?	12 October 2026, 10:00 AM.	None
What is the revised estimated delivery time?	12 October 2026, 4:00 PM in the original scenario.	Confirm latest estimate before sending; live-change scenario updates it to 6:00 PM.
Why is the shipment delayed?	Vehicle breakdown during transit.	None
What recovery action is underway?	Replacement vehicle arranged; cargo transfer in progress.	Cargo condition is not confirmed.
How much refund will I receive?	Not provided; refund is not automatic.	Delivery-fee review may be requested for 4+ hours; any refund requires approval. Amount and decision need authorisation.
Where is the vehicle currently located?	Not provided.	Live vehicle location is unavailable; confirm through an authorised tracking source if needed.

Usefulness: the table helps support staff distinguish facts from unknowns and identify when approval or a new source is required before answering.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Round 5 structured-output table.

Round 6 — Audience-Based Prompting

A. Customer SMS (original timeline; under 50 words)

FreshRoute Logistics: Shipment FR208 for GreenBasket Retail is now estimated for delivery at 4:00 PM on 12 October 2026 due to a vehicle breakdown. A replacement vehicle is arranged and cargo transfer is in progress. Next update: 1:00 PM. Delivery time is an estimate.

B. Internal warehouse coordination briefing (under 100 words)

Shipment FR208: 100 cartons of packaged biscuits moving from the Delhi warehouse to the Jaipur retail distribution centre. Scheduled delivery was 12 October 2026 at 10:00 AM; the current original estimate is 4:00 PM due to a vehicle breakdown during transit. A replacement vehicle has been arranged and cargo transfer is in progress. The next customer update is due at 1:00 PM. Confirm cargo condition and any current vehicle location through authorised operational sources; neither has been supplied. Do not promise a refund: a delivery-fee review may be requested for delays of four hours or more, and refunds require approval.

Comparison point	Customer SMS	Internal briefing
Audience	Customer / recipient	Warehouse coordination team
Tone	Brief, courteous, easy to understand	Operational and action-focused
Detail level	Essential delivery facts and next update	Cargo quantity, route, recovery and unknowns
Unknowns	Does not claim cargo condition or refund	Calls out items that need authorised confirmation

The customer needs a concise update about what to expect. The warehouse team needs shipment quantity, route, recovery status and the facts that still require confirmation.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Round 6 customer SMS and internal briefing.

Live Change Challenge — Updated Operational Timings

New source update: estimated delivery is now 6:00 PM on 12 October 2026. The next customer update is now 3:00 PM. All other supplied information remains unchanged.

Prompt used to update the messages:

Update the FR208 customer email and customer SMS using the latest operational change: revised estimated delivery is 12 October 2026 at 6:00 PM, and the next customer update is 12 October 2026 at 3:00 PM. Replace all earlier timings in the customer-facing messages. Preserve all other supplied facts, including the vehicle breakdown, replacement vehicle and cargo transfer in progress, the delivery-fee review policy and unconfirmed cargo condition. Do not guarantee arrival, promise a refund or invent live location, driver details or cargo condition.

Updated customer email

Subject: Updated Delivery Estimate — Shipment FR208

Dear GreenBasket Retail Team,
We apologise for the inconvenience. Shipment FR208, containing 100 cartons of packaged biscuits and travelling from the Delhi warehouse to the Jaipur retail distribution centre, was scheduled for delivery at 10:00 AM on 12 October 2026. Following a vehicle breakdown during transit, delivery is now estimated for 6:00 PM. A replacement vehicle has been arranged and cargo transfer is in progress. Our next update will be at 3:00 PM. You may request a delivery-fee review for a delay of four hours or more; any refund requires approval. Cargo condition is not yet confirmed.

Updated customer SMS (under 50 words)

FreshRoute Logistics: Shipment FR208 is now estimated for delivery at 6:00 PM on 12 October 2026 following a vehicle breakdown. A replacement vehicle is arranged and cargo transfer is in progress. Next update: 3:00 PM. Arrival time is an estimate, not a guarantee.

Check performed: I compared both updated messages with the live-change instruction and confirmed that the old 4:00 PM delivery estimate and 1:00 PM update were removed from customer-facing copy.

EVIDENCE TO ADD: Live change prompt and both updated messages.

Manual Verification

Detail to check	Correct information	Correct in final output?	Correction made, if needed
Shipment ID	FR208	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Estimated delivery	12 October 2026, 6:00 PM	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Next update	12 October 2026, 3:00 PM	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Delay reason	Vehicle breakdown during transit	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Recovery action	Replacement vehicle arranged; cargo transfer in progress	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Fee review policy	May request review for 4+ hour delay; refund requires approval	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Cargo condition	Not confirmed	■ Yes / ■ No	_____
Delivery wording	Estimate, not guarantee	■ Yes / ■ No	_____

Manual timing check: 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM is an eight-hour delay. This exceeds the four-hour threshold to request a delivery-fee review, but a refund is not automatic and requires approval.

Reflection

1. Most useful strategy: Context and constraints produced the most useful output because it gave the AI verified shipment facts and boundaries around refunds, cargo condition and timing. Structured output was also helpful for quickly identifying unknown information.
2. Effect of adding context: The first message was polite but generic. Adding shipment ID, route, timing, delay reason, recovery action and next update made the message specific and useful.
3. Unsupported claim or potential error: I checked for an automatic refund promise and any claim that the cartons were undamaged. Neither is supported by the source, so both must remain unconfirmed.
4. Customer vs internal message: The customer message is brief and focuses on the updated estimate and next update. The internal briefing includes quantity, route, recovery action and operational unknowns that staff should verify.
5. Human verification: A human must verify the latest timings, delay calculation, policy wording, cargo condition and any operational details before the message is sent. AI output is a draft, not a live tracking source.

GitHub Portfolio

Repository: logistics-ai-portfolio

Suggested folder structure

```
logistics-ai-portfolio/  
  README.md  
  lab-01-delivery-delay-communication/  
    Lab-01-YourName.docx  
    Lab-01-YourName.pdf  
    screenshots/
```

README.md content

AI-Assisted Logistics Customer Service

- **Business problem:** Communicating a delayed shipment accurately to a customer and an internal coordination team.
- **Tools used:** ChatGPT or Gemini, Microsoft Word, GitHub.
- **Strategies practised:** Zero-shot, context and constraints, role prompting, few-shot, structured output and audience-based prompting.
- **Outputs created:** Customer email, FAQ responses, support table, SMS and internal briefing.
- **My contribution:** [Describe your prompt changes, checks and corrections in your own words.]
- **Key learning:** [Explain your most useful learning.]
- **Limitations:** This is a classroom simulation using fictional information. It is not connected to live shipment tracking systems.

AI-use declaration

I used [tool name] to generate and refine draft communication. I checked the outputs against the supplied fictional facts and policy. The observations, verification and reflection are my own work.

Final Submission Checklist

- All six rounds are documented.
- Readable screenshots of actual prompts and responses are inserted.
- Live change challenge uses 6:00 PM delivery estimate and 3:00 PM next update.
- Manual verification table is completed.
- Observations and reflections are personalised in my own words.
- Word and PDF files are uploaded to the correct GitHub folder.
- No personal customer information appears in the files.